

OLDER CAN = MORE INFLUENTIAL

Article I just read.

We should be intentional about parlaying our years into influence. Being critical will kill our influence. There will come a time when influence is all we will have to offer – If we have been critical no one will want what we are offering.

Older people who influenced me.

I know I am getting older because I finally know my way around, but you don't feel like going.

When I bend down to tie my shoes, I ask myself the question, *“Is there anything else I need to do while I'm down here?”*

The gleam in my eye is the sun reflecting off of my trifocals.

I finally got it all together, but have forgotten where I put it!

Someone has said that you're as old as you feel! When the late Bob Hope was 100 years old, someone asked him how it felt to be 100. He said, *"I don't feel anything until about noon, and then I take a nap."*

How can we make Older = More influential?

I. BE SURE YOU'RE RIGHT WITH GOD AND MAN

That's foundational. Proverbs 16:31 says, *"The gray head is a crown of glory, IF it be found in the way of righteousness."*

Paul Powell said: *"We are to be faithful not just until we're tired, or until we are retired. We are to be faithful until we are expired--until our going or his coming."*

II. RADIATE A POSITIVE ATTITUDE

Psalm 1:1, “*Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.*”

What does it mean to “sit in the seat of the scornful?” It means to be hyper-critical, overly negative, always looking at the dark side. This is an attitude we must avoid at all costs.

Well, people hear enough discouraging words in today’s world; what they need is optimism and encouragement—and you and I need to radiate that kind of a spirit if we’re going to maintain influence in our senior years.

III. MAINTAIN A SENSE OF HUMOR

Proverbs 17:22 says that “*A merry heart doeth good like a medicine*”—and the wonderful thing is that there aren’t any side effects.

It helps, in every department of life, to have a sense of humor. An elderly man had been courting an elderly lady for quite some time.

One evening they were sitting together in her living room. He got off the couch, got on his knees in front of her, and said, *“I have two questions. First, will you marry me?”* She said, *“Yes. What’s the second question?”* He said, *“Will you help me up?”*

An elderly man and his wife went to a crowded restaurant one night and were told by the host that it would be 45 minutes before he could seat them. The man said, *“Young fellow, my wife and I are both 90 years old; we may not have 45 minutes.”* They were seated immediately.

A man very advanced in age was getting married. His friends said, *“Tell us about her. Is she a good cook?”* He said, *“I don’t know.”* They said, *“Is she a good housekeeper?”* He said, *“I don’t know.”* They said, *“Well, why are you marrying her?”* He said, *“She drives at night.”*

IV. KEEP UP CONTACTS WITH OTHER PEOPLE

Romans 14:7 says, *“For none of us liveth to himself, and no man dieth to himself.”* John Donne, a 17th century writer, said: *“No man is an island, entire of itself....”*

In his famous sermon, *“The Conquest of Fear,”* the late Dr. George Truett was speaking about our need to be involved with other people. He said, *“Occasionally the vaunting, swelling word is heard, ‘I’m independent now.’”* Truett said, *“Oh, You are? Independent of whom, and when, and where, and how?”* He said, *“We’re bound together in the bundle of life....We are dependent—utterly upon God, and to a marked degree upon one another.”*

We desperately need each other – We were made for community.

V. ALWAYS HAVE A THANKFUL ATTITUDE

1 Thessalonians 5:18 says, *“In everything give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.”*

We're to be thankful not only for those rare, once-in-a-blue-moon blessings—but we're also to be thankful for those everyday blessings—those blessings that we tend to take for granted, because we're so used to them.

We need to thank him for each beautiful sunset, and for all the wonders of nature. Emerson said that *“If the stars came out only once a year, we would all want to stay up and see them; but because they are visible so much of the time, we hardly notice them.”*

“In everything give thanks.” T

Conclusion

I love these lines by Herbert A. White, entitled “A Living Faith”:

“I’ve dreamed many dreams that never came true, I’ve seen them vanish at dawn, But I’ve realized enough of my dreams, thank God,

TO MAKE ME WANT TO DREAM ON.

I’ve prayed many prayers when no answer came

Though I waited patient and long, But answers
have come to enough of my prayers

TO MAKE ME KEEP PRAYING ON.

I've trusted many a friend that failed, And left
me to weep alone, But I've found enough of my
friends true blue

TO MAKE ME KEEP TRUSTING ON.

I've sown many seed that fell by the way
For the birds to feed upon, But I've held enough
golden sheaves in my hands

TO MAKE ME KEEP SOWING ON.

I've drained the cup of disappointment and pain
And gone many days without song, But I've
sipped enough nectar from the roses of life

TO MAKE ME WANT TO LIVE ON.”

Jesus said, in John 16:33, “*These things I have
spoken unto you, that in me ye might have
peace. In the world ye shall have tribulation:
but be of good cheer; I have overcome the
world.*”

The “bottom line” as to how to grow older while influencing others is how we live and the attitude with which we face the challenges of life.